

is available

5. Convert your objects using script
6. Convert your queries
7. Extract data from the existing system
8. Check performance
9. Your system is ready to work

When to go for manual

migration: Nothing beats human precision; no tool can replace a pro sysadmin. But the catch is—can you afford it? It's also a very time-consuming process, so plan ahead with ample time.

We will now focus on the automated process, which is generally applicable on a diverse populace. All you need is a decent understanding of the RDBMS—a demigod will do.

There are various tools available for database migration that can be used for automated migrations. Some of the recommended ones are:

1. MySQL Migration Toolkit: This is a freely available tool from MySQL. It converts only your tables and relations to MySQL.
2. SwissSQL: It converts tables, views and queries.
3. SQLWays: It converts tables, views, relations, stored procedure, functions and sequence. It will not convert packages and triggers.

We will quickly run through migration from Oracle to MySQL using the MySQL Migration Toolkit:

1. Choose the source database from where you want to migrate your database—that is, Oracle, SQL Server, etc. Also choose the proper method to connect to your source database.
2. Choose your target database server to which you want to migrate your existing system. It may be your local host, or any other system.
3. Choose schema from a list of schema to migrate. You can migrate one or more than one DB at the same time.
4. Select the object to migrate from the schema. You can choose

a table, view, procedure and function. But the MySQL migration toolkit will migrate only tables and views.

5. Select the migration method.
6. Create MySQL target objects: Choose how you want to migrate your object. Also choose if you want to generate a script for the same.
7. Migrate data to MySQL: You can choose to transfer data online and also can create a script for the database migration.
8. Review the migration: Ask yourself, what was successfully migrated; if something wasn't migrated, what needs to be done manually? You can also generate a report about the migration.

Voila! That's it and it wasn't difficult, was it?

Even though I have been pushing MySQL as the best solution for your database needs, be warned: MySQL comes with its own limitations and constraints.

Constraints of MySQL

MySQL contains a wide array of new features and supports all new-age technologies, yet there are some things that are still missing in MySQL. These include:

- Lack of support for packages
- No raise error capability
- Sending e-mails
- Generating application errors and logs
- Exception handling

Apart from these, MySQL will make for a splendid solution that can resolve almost any database requirement.

I hope you found this article useful. I would love to hear your feedback and queries. 

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